46TH ANNIVERSARY

YOUTHSPEAK

PUMDEE GAMLIN, 20
ITANAGAR

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Fascinating India

India as a country has always fascinated the outside world. I hope India in the future continues to do so, and for good reasons. I hope India is able to acknowledge, appreciate and celebrate the diverse and unique cultures present here, something that has been lacking for a few years now. I hope in the future, India is full of educated people, people who won't give in to the rhetoric of religion. Last but not the least, I sincerely hope India is able to recognise the sheer volume of corruption which takes place in the largest democracy of the world. If that doesn't happen, my dream of India will never come true. ■





PREYRANA MISHRA, 19, BHUBANESWAR

Computer Science Engineering, KIIT University, **Bhubaneswar**

Safety for All

I would like to see a more inclusive India, which is safe and offers dignity to every individual. It is important to see which areas can be immediately improved. For example, women's safety—how often do we hear those in power talking about this issue? It took India five years to sentence to death people who were 100 per cent culprits of a heinous crime like rape. With stricter laws and better implementation, this can change drastically.

The safety of non-binary or transgender groups is another issue. The social acceptance of these groups still seems a far-fetched idea, despite us living in a county where the majority of the population worships the gender fluid Lord Shiva. ■

–S. Sahaya Ranjit, Kaushik Deka, Amarnath K. Menon, Rohit Parihar, Romita Datta, Shelly Anand, Aditi Pai, Rahul Noronha, Aravind Gowda